Window Grille

From the mosque of Sidi Abdallah al-Sharif, Damietta

Ottoman, 1072 AH / 1661-62 CE

Wood

W: 105.5; H: 140 cm

Inv. no. 4392



Wooden window grille from the mosque of Sidi Abdallah al-Sharif in Damietta. The panel bears two inscriptions executed in a clear naskh script, notable for broad, flat, raised strokes and fully articulated diacritics. The upper inscription, arranged across three narrow horizontal bands separated by vertical mouldings, paraphrases Qur'an 9:18 (Surat al-Tawbah) and records the restoration of the mosque by the amir al-liwa Dilawar in 1072 AH (1661-62), accompanied by a prayer for divine reward and continued

prosperity. Beyond his title, equivalent in later Ottoman usage to a military rank comparable to a brigadier general, little is known of the patron. A second inscription, set within the central panel and arranged in two registers, bears a shahada. The remaining surface is articulated by eight openwork panels executed in the abu ganzeer technique, showcasing interlocking geometric patterns characteristic of late medieval Egyptian woodwork.

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